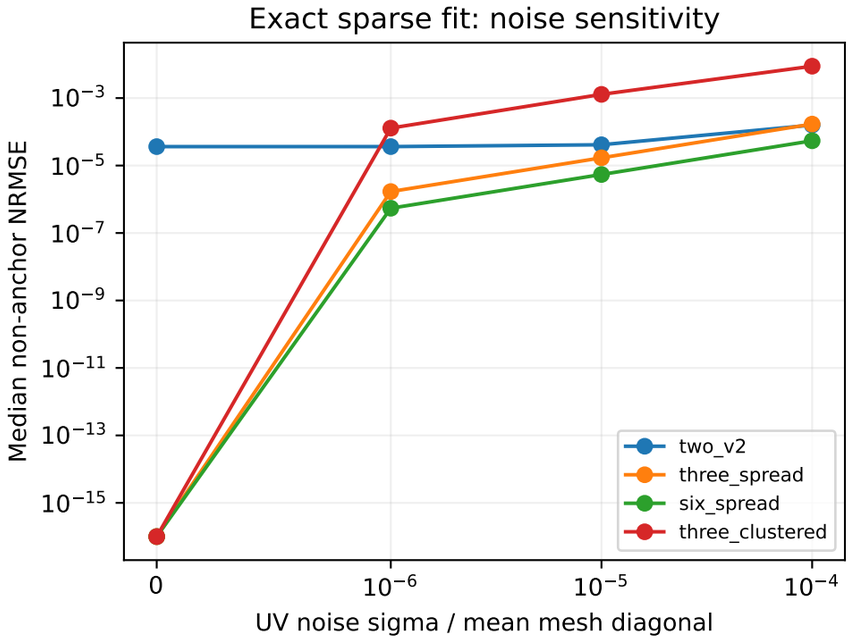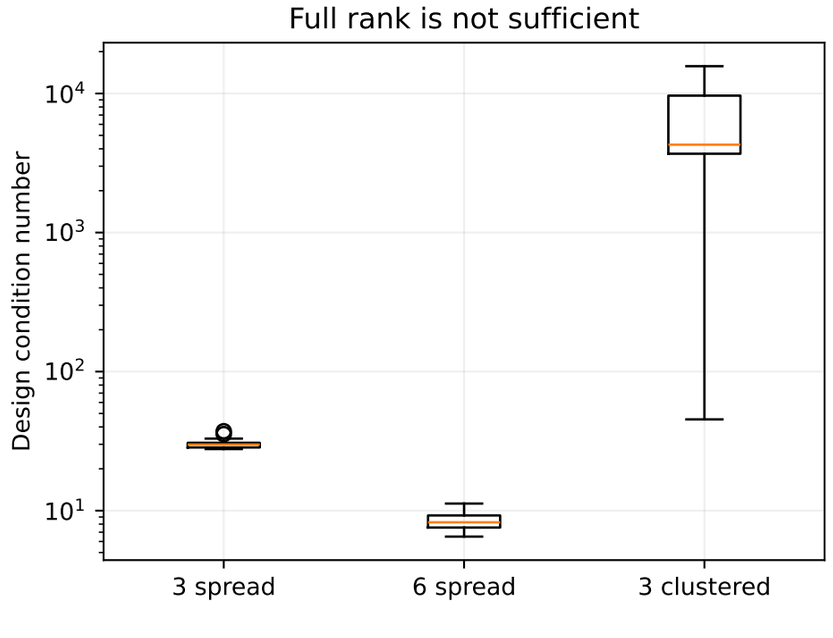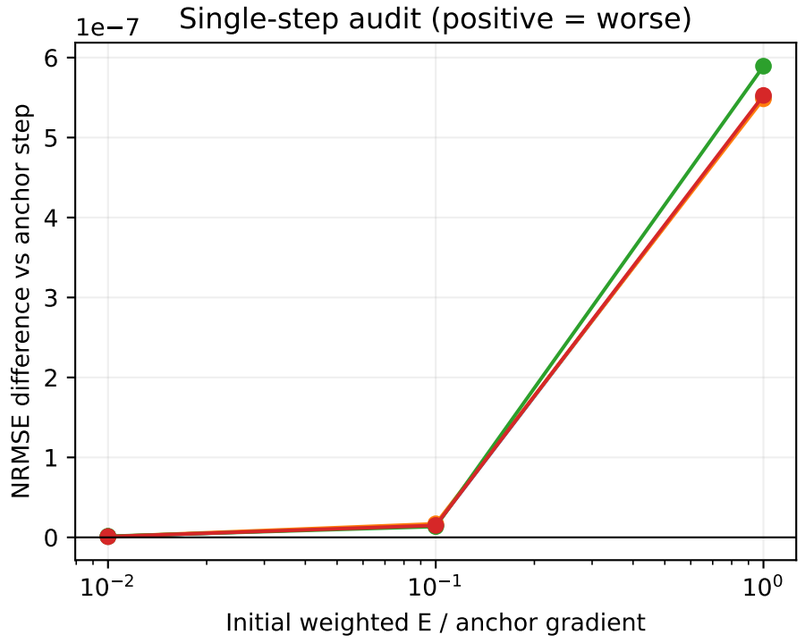S3.6 v3: synthetic observations; no network eligibility